

A post-singularity galactic civilization has converted the galaxy's matter to computation. It studies one man's Tuesday. Robert Allen Kessler, claims adjuster, Columbus, Ohio, saw light on a river and felt four seconds of happiness he never told anyone about. Twelve hundred years later, a stellar-scale intelligence devotes its vast resources to reconstructing every detail of that day. It knows his shoe size. It knows the scratch on his kitchen table. It cannot know what the light looked like to him. The physics is real. The numbers are right. The hard problem of consciousness is the last problem, and it outlasts the stars.

What's It Like To Be Bob?

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Alex Towell